



FREE GUIDE · FOR EMS & FIRE DEPARTMENTS

The EMS / Fire Department's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Narcotics on every rig, field sharps, and ambulance
biohazard — the DEA watches field wasting closely.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Narcotics ride on every rig.

EMS agencies and fire departments carry controlled narcotics on every rig — fentanyl, morphine, midazolam — and wasted, expired, and unused doses must be destroyed non-retrievable under DEA rules that scrutinize field wasting closely. Add field sharps and ambulance biohazard, and you have real regulated waste in motion. This guide covers every stream.

The good news

One DEA-registered partner gives your medics a compliant way to destroy wasted and expired narcotics — with witnessed logs and Form 41 — plus field sharps and biohazard, documented every time. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Controlled substances

Rig narcotics — wasted, expired, and unused controlled doses.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II–V narcotics
- Wasted & partial field doses
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled destruction to DEA standards, with documentation.

Tip

Log and witness every wasted controlled dose — the DEA checks the paper trail.

WASTE STREAM 02

Sharps

Field and ambulance injection and IV sharps.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- IV & injection needles
- Intraosseous & auto-injector sharps
- Syringes & lancets

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 03

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Trauma and treatment biohazard from the ambulance.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-soaked trauma materials
- Contaminated PPE & dressings
- Ambulance biohazard

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

WASTE STREAM 04

Pharmaceutical waste

Expired non-controlled medications from the rig.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired non-controlled meds
- Discontinued rig stock
- Non-controlled supplies

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own path)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The EMS / fire compliance checklist.

- ☐ Wasted and expired narcotics rendered non-retrievable, witnessed and logged, with Form 41.
- ☐ A defensible field-wasting paper trail (the DEA scrutinizes EMS closely).
- ☐ Field and ambulance sharps in FDA-cleared containers.

- ☐ Trauma biohazard red-bagged and destroyed.
- ☐ Expired non-controlled rig meds destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Manifests and Certificates of Destruction retained per DEA and state rules.

QUESTIONS EMS AGENCIES ASK

Your EMS questions, answered.

How do we handle wasted narcotics in the field?

Witness and log each wasted dose per your protocol, then render the collected controlled waste non-retrievable with a DEA Form 41. The wasting log plus a Certificate of Destruction keeps your records audit-ready — the area the DEA examines most for EMS.

What do we do with expired rig narcotics?

Rendered non-retrievable and documented with a Form 41 — never trashed or flushed.

Can you cover multiple stations or apparatus?

Yes — one program and unified documentation across every station and rig, no contract.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle gives EMS and fire agencies DEA-compliant destruction for wasted and expired narcotics — witnessed, Form 41 handled — plus field sharps and ambulance biohazard, documented every time. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Rig narcotics (wasted/expired)	Controlled destruction (Form 41, wasting logs)
Field & ambulance sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Trauma biohazard	Biohazard kit or pickup

Waste stream

The right path

**Expired non-controlled
meds**

Pharmaceutical waste kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Multi-station departments often prefer scheduled pickup with unified reporting. We'll build it — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY EMS AGENCIES & FIRE DEPARTMENTS CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your EMS agency waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop